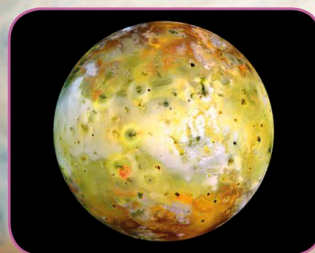


GALILEO

Space probe

Controllers ended the mission by **crashing** Galileo into Jupiter.

Named after the great early astronomer, the unmanned Galileo spacecraft was the first to orbit Jupiter – the planet he had studied in the early 17th century. During eight years in orbit, the probe took pictures of Jupiter's clouds, rings, and biggest moons – finding evidence for hidden oceans. A smaller probe launched by Galileo also sampled Jupiter's atmosphere.



Jupiter's moon Io as seen by Galileo

DATA FILE



SIZE: 5.3 m (17 ft) long



DATE OF LAUNCH: 18 October 1989



MISSION DURATION: 13 years, 11 months, 3 days (de-orbited)



SPACE AGENCY: NASA